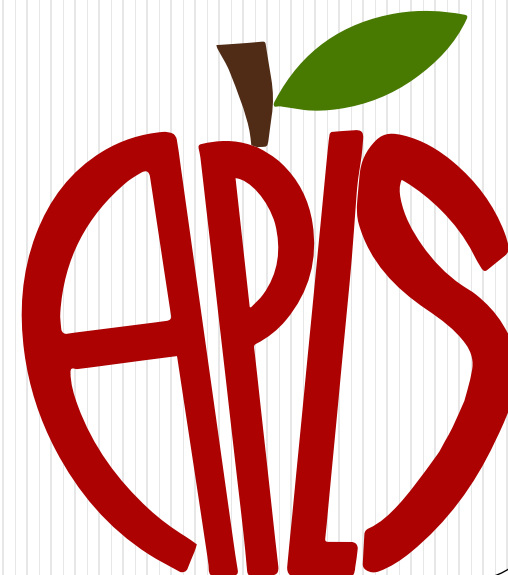


Introducing the Archive of Pittsburgh Language and Speech (APLS), a publicly accessible multilayer speech corpus

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Outline

- What is APLS?
- What can APLS do?
- What can *you* do with APLS?



What is APLS?

- A publicly accessible corpus of Pittsburgh socioLx interviews

Journal of English Linguistics



Restricted access | Research article | First published June 2006

Mobility, Indexicality, and the Enregisterment of “Pittsburghese”

[Barbara Johnstone](#), [Jennifer Andrus](#), and [Andrew E. Danielson](#) [View all authors and affiliations](#)

[Volume 34, Issue 2](#) | <https://doi.org/10.1177/0075424206290692>

*Barbara Johnstone, Daniel Baumgardt,
Maeve Eberhardt, Scott Kiesling*
**PITTSBURGH SPEECH
AND PITTSBURGHESSE**

ES IN SOCIOLINGUISTICS

BARBARA JOHNSTONE

**SPEAKING
PITTSBURGHESSE**
THE STORY OF A DIALECT

CHAPTER 12

AFRICAN AMERICAN
LANGUAGE IN
PITTSBURGH
AND THE LOWER
SUSQUEHANNA VALLEY

JENNIFER BLOOMQUIST AND SHELOME GOODEN

Language & Communication
Volume 32, Issue 4, October 2012, Pages 358-371

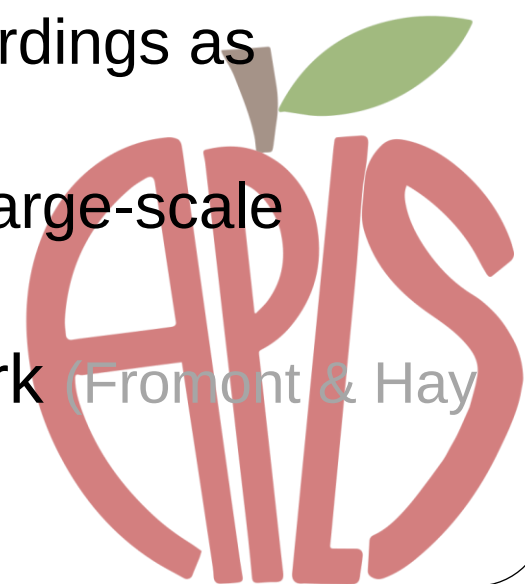


Enregisterment of Pittsburghese and
the local African American community

Maeve Eberhardt

What is APLS?

- A publicly accessible corpus of Pittsburgh socioLx interviews
 - Currently in "preview release" – more on that later
- Contains:
 - **recordings** of interviews conducted with speakers native to Pittsburgh and surrounding neighborhoods
 - **annotations** of linguistic information at the level of phrases, words, and individual speech sounds, allowing us to treat these recordings as structured linguistic data, organized into **layers**
 - **metadata** on interviewees and transcripts that facilitate large-scale (socio)linguistic analysis
- Powered by LaBB-CAT corpus management framework (Fromont & Hay 2012)



What can APLS do?

- Display transcript data & play audio files in context
- Perform complex searches across multiple layers using regular expressions
- Export annotation data to csv, TextGrid
- Export audio fragments to wav
- Perform batch acoustic measurements in Praat, including custom Praat scripts
- Accessible via both webpage GUI and R & Python libraries



What can APLS do?

- Case study: coronal stop deletion
- Complex variable context:
 - lexical restrictions (ignoring stop-words like *and* or ending in *-n't*)
 - phonological context (preceding consonant, no following coronal stop)
 - prosodic context (word-final)
- APLS can handle these requirements easily in its multi-layer search



What can *you* do with APLS?

- Sign up for a free user account at <https://apls.pitt.edu>
- Still a "preview" release (1.0 to be released this spring)
 - Adding new transcripts (eventually: 45 hours from 40 interviewees)
 - Refining the user interface & some back-end details
 - Fleshing out documentation
- I welcome your questions, feedback, and suggestions for improvement
 - APLS is meant to be actually useful for researchers, so any ideas you have are a real help!



Thanks! Questions?

Thanks to Scott Kiesling, Barbara Johnstone, Robert Fromont, members of the Computational Sociolinguistics Lab past and present, and—most of all—the speakers who have shared their voices with us

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DISC phonemic alphabet

- You might've noticed some funny symbols for sounds. What's up with that?
- Internally, APLS uses the DISC alphabet, which uses ASCII characters to represent English phonemes
 - IPA used for transcript display
- Advantages:
 - No variability in representations (e.g., *prize* can be /aɪ/ or /aj/ or /ai/)
 - No lookalike characters (e.g., <g> for <g>)
 - No digraphs for diphthongs or affricates

